

# *Rosary Devotions*

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## THE JOYFUL MYSTERIES

### I. The Annunciation

Read St. Luke i. 26-38

Contemplate the Blessed Virgin rapt in silent prayer in the holy house at Nazareth. The chamber suddenly filled with heavenly splendor. The angelic messenger appearing, crying "Hail, full of Grace." The wondrous Announcement,—the Virgin's fear,—the words of comfort and reassurance, "Be it unto me according to thy word," "And the Word was made flesh and dwelt among us."

(After the meditation on each Mystery, say 1 Our Father, 10 Hail Marys, 1 Gloria).

Resolution: To meet God's calls with our Lady's reply.

### II. The Visitation

Read St. Luke i. 39-56

Arise, my soul, in haste and go with the Blessed Mother to the hill country. She bears beneath her heart the Incarnate God. Her immaculate womb is the shrine where God is dwelling. There the Sacred Heart beats with a mighty love for those He longs to redeem,—yes for you. Picture the house in the hill country. Mary's entrance, the manifestation of the Holy Ghost, the loud and joyful cry of the aged Elizabeth. The unborn Baptist leaping in his mother's womb. Mary magnifying God.

Resolution: To magnify God, saying Magnificat.

## III. The Nativity

Read St. Luke ii. 4-20; St. Matt. ii. 1-11

Bethlehem, with its crowded streets; the Holy Mother begging a shelter: "No room for them"; shut out in the winter night. Follow them to the stable. The bitter cold; the keen night wind; the shivering Infant in the straw. Kneel with Blessed Mary and St. Joseph and worship Him. He smiles up into your face. Kiss those little hands reaching out in love to you. Lift Him to your bosom, warm Him with your heart's best love. But hark!—a burst of heavenly music. Angels singing high amongst the Christmas stars. Swift steps approach. Shepherds throng the manger-throne, kneeling in love and worship at His feet. Beneath a flaming star a stately caravan draws near, Kings from far off lands kneel and offer gold, frankincense and myrrh. What shall I offer?

Resolution: I pledge to the Infant Jesus the gold of my heart's love, the incense of my prayers, the myrrh of my willingness to bear my cross.

## IV. The Presentation

Read St. Luke ii. 22-28

A humble procession to the Temple gates,—St. Joseph, Mary the Blessed of the Father, in her arms the tender Infant who is Incarnate God Most High. Purer than the seraphim, she makes her offering for her purification. The aged priest draws near; he clasps the Infant to



his heart; "Lord, now lettest Thou Thy servant depart in peace . . . for mine eyes have seen Thy Salvation." Rejoice with Simeon in the Light of the Gentiles, in the Glory of Israel.

Resolution: To say, "Come to my heart Lord Jesus."

## **V. The Finding in the Temple**

Read St. Luke ii. 41-52

The Child Jesus lost in the great city! Meditate upon the search by Blessed Mary and St. Joseph through the agonizing days. "Verily, Thou art a God, that hidest Thyself." What is my search for Him when He seems to withdraw Himself and my soul is dark? How can I find Him again? "I went into the temple of God; then understood I these things." Linger over the joy of this Finding,—the Mother holding the Holy Child to her heart again. He is on His Father's business, to love us, to teach us, to redeem us. Like Blessed Mary, take this Holy Child to your heart. "I found Him whom my soul loveth; I held Him and would not let Him go."

Resolution: I will seek Him whom my soul loveth.

## **THE SORROWFUL MYSTERIES**

### **I. The Agony in the Garden**

Read St. Matt. xxvi. 36-46

Picture the midnight scene. The paschal moon flooding the world with silver light,—the deep

shade of the olive grove,—the sleeping disciples,—Jesus our God and Lord, bowed down in agony. See the blood-tears falling. Hear the cry wrung from His Heart: O My Father, if it be possible, let this Cup pass from Me; nevertheless not as I will, but as Thou wilt. He suffers for my sins. The cup which He drinks to the bitter dregs my self-will filled for him. O God, have mercy upon me and forgive. O Jesus, with Thy Precious Blood, blot out my sins, my many sins.

Resolution: To say, "Have mercy on me, O God."

### **II. The Scourging**

Read St. Luke xxiii. 13-16

Pilate, hoping to pacify the Jews, delivers Jesus to the torture of the Roman scourge. See Him bound to the pillar. Stroke falls upon stroke, the leathern thongs, sink deep into the flesh at every blow. O my soul, hear the piteous moans of thy Saviour. Behold the stripes by which thou art healed. See the Precious Blood starting from the red track of the whip as the keen lash is withdrawn. Not Pilate, but my sins deliver Him to the torture.

Resolution: An Act of love in reparation to Jesus.

### **III. The Crowning with Thorns**

Read St. John xix. 2-3

See the Son of God crowned, robed and sceptered. Men kneel in mockery,—“Hail, King



of the Jews!"—then with brutal laughter they spit upon His Sacred Face, once so fair and comely. Beneath the cruel thorns great blood-drops flow. His face is marred with Blood. Patient, silent, He suffers. His Sacred Heart is breaking with love. And who is it who treats the loving Saviour thus? Look up into His eyes, all dimmed with blood, and ask, "Lord, is it I?"

Resolution: To say, "Thy Kingdom Come," three times.

#### **IV. Bearing the Cross**

Read St. Luke xxiii. 27

Follow with Mary along the Way of Sorrows. See Jesus as He toils up the steep ascent, burdened with the Cross. He makes no reply to the jeers, the curses, the blows and spitting. Thrice He sinks beneath the heavy load. Hell roars in horrid triumph as Incarnate God falls down upon the way. His feet are cut by the stones. Here, as everywhere, He is prodigal of His Precious Blood in His longing to cleanse our souls.

Resolutions: To say, "Jesus, Jesus, Jesus."

#### **V. The Crucifixion**

Read St. Mark xv. 23-38

See Jesus transfixed upon the Cross. Hear the hammer blows as the nails are driven through His tender flesh. The Precious Blood streams forth. Hear His cry: "Father, forgive them!" For six hours amid darkness and earthquake, He hangs. "Come down from the Cross," they

cry, "Save Thyself." But He came not to save Himself, but me, a poor sinner. Stand close beside the Cross with the Holy Mother and St. John. Give Him your heart. Only that gift can ease His pain. He longs so for it. Can you keep it from him?

Resolution: Say thrice, "Knit my heart unto Thee."

### **THE GLORIOUS MYSTERIES**

#### **I. The Resurrection**

Read St. Matt. xxviii. 1-10

Again, night in her silent course. The world in slumber lies. Jesus, dead and buried, sleeps in the tomb. Suddenly a flash of heavenly glory. An Angel leaps down from heaven, and the earth quakes beneath his mighty touch. The Incarnate Son takes once more the life He had laid down of Himself, breaks the bars of death, and rises in triumph from the tomb. Hear His joyful greeting to the holy woman. "All hail!" Hear His loving greeting to your soul. "Peace be unto you."

Resolution: To kneel and kiss his sacred feet.

#### **II. The Ascension**

Read St. Luke xxiv. 50-51

See the vast cohorts of angels coming to hail Him as their King; the hosts of patriarchs and prophets, caught up from their place of waiting to greet the Lord in the air. What march of heavenly splendor as they sweep upward to



the everlasting gates with a mighty shout: "Lift up your heads, O ye gates and the King of Glory shall come in." Closed to man by man's sins, heaven is flung wide open at the approach of the God-Man, never again to be shut against the sons of men.

Resolution: Not to disappoint Him as He waits for me at the gates of Paradise.

### **III. The Coming of the Holy Ghost**

Read Acts i. 13-14 and ii. 1-4

The disciples gathered with Mary the Mother of Jesus for the first Christian novena and retreat. What reward for perseverance in prayer! The "Power of the Most High" is liberated, God the Holy Ghost comes down to crown with the living Flame of Love His faithful ones. Is thy heart cold? Pray the fire of the Holy Ghost into it. Rejoice with Blessed Mary and all the Saints in His power, His love, His tender guiding care.

Resolution: Yield today to every call of conscience.

### **IV. The Assumption of the B. V. M.**

Read St. Luke i. 38 and

I Kings ii. 19-20

She who called herself "the handmaid (literally slave-maid) of the Lord," now exalted as Queen of Heaven. That holy, undefiled flesh from which God the Son took His Human Body, could not see corruption. Although with-

out sin, she died the death common to all; but her divine Son would not permit death to hold her, but in the beloved city He gave her rest, and in Jerusalem was her power. Raised up to reign with Christ in Glory, she shares His work of intercession. O happy thought! The Mother of God prays for me!

Resolution: To try to be worthy of Mary's love.

### **V. The Coronation of the B. V. M.**

Read Rev. xii. 1 and 2 Timothy iv. 8

The Coronation of the Mother of God follows upon the reception into Heaven. But not only is a crown given to her. He who crowned her is waiting to crown us, if we follow the example of the Holy Mother. A crown is prepared for me and for all those who love His appearing. Come quickly, Lord Jesus.

Resolution: To say when next tempted: "Hold that fast which thou hast, that no man take thy crown."